

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

We take you down the Hero's Journey, or the monomyth featuring famous characters from pop culture and we share some SFW porn. We also give you our reviews for a latest film, streaming series, comic and anime.



The changing human skeleton

Modern life is changing human skeletons, and researchers can almost see it happening in front of their eyes. The bases of skulls are developing support structures for prolonged smartphone use. Because of a more sedentary lifestyle, our skeletons are becoming fragile, and our elbows are shrinking. Because of an increase in soft foods, our jaws are becoming weaker. <https://dgit.in/aistudy>

WHAT'S NEW

Capuchin monkeys are in the stone age

Researchers have found an archeological record of stone tool use in capuchin monkeys from Brazil. The record goes back 3,000 years, indicating that these monkeys have been in their stone age for that long. The sizes of the stone tools have changed over time, indicating that the monkeys had been adapting to accessing different kinds of food. It is unknown why the diet changed, maybe the groups of monkeys in the site had different tastes, or there were changes in the local flora. The monkeys also accidentally create flakes from the stones during their hammering. Ancient humans used to deliberately create such flakes, and use the flakes for cutting and scraping. Studying the stone tools



used by the capuchin monkeys, provides insight into the stone tool used by humans and other species of the homo genus. The stone tools can guide researchers on what kind of stones to look

for when investigating the oldest archeological sites for human tool use. The capuchin monkeys are not the only primate species to use stone tools. Others, such as the macaques chimpanzees use stone hammers to crack open nuts.

<https://dgit.in/capusa>

Regulating tech giants makes them stronger

Apple, Google, Facebook and Amazon have grown so big, that regulators see them as companies that will dominate the technology landscape for a long time. Regulations coming in place would require these companies to police their users, make sure there are no copyright violations, and ensure their privacy. These are powers that were traditionally assumed by the state. The introduction of new regulations will be expensive for most smaller com-



panies to comply, which leaves only the biggest tech companies. As a consequence, the smaller companies trying to get a piece of the cake will face an unfair disadvantage. The recent spate of regulations have only worked

to consolidate the power of these companies, which have implications for privacy, free speech and safety of the users. The regulations imposed by the EU and the US have in effect, given a license to these companies to continue to dominate the market. The problem arises because the regulations have to keep up with the advancement in tech, and no one really has experience in breaking up a technology monopoly.

<https://dgit.in/regtec>



Uber's road to perdition

Uber has grown aggressively, but has never made a profit. The idea was to become a monopoly, then take in the profit. Uber has not achieved the status of platforms such as Facebook or Amazon. Uber has not yet reduced the cost or improved the productivity of taxi services.

<https://dgit.in/uberdes>



The invention of the bicycle

The bicycle is a pretty simple machine, and a vital one for mobility. Why did it take so long for the bicycle to be invented? While there are many contributing factors, the main reasons were that the design was not obvious, neither were the materials needed, and it had to be economically viable.

<https://dgit.in/bykhistry>



AI-driven discoveries

An AI trained to go through scientific papers made connections that were missed by scientists. The AI came up with new materials for heating and cooling. Another test, allowed the AI to come up with a discovery that had been made by humans in 2012. The approach is used in a number of fields.

<https://dgit.in/skelegro>